

Tennis Star Jannik Sinner Takes a Break to Heal His Knee

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-10-06 3 min read

Jannik Sinner is the number one men's tennis player in the world. But he will not play again in 2026. The 25-year-old from Italy has a hurt right knee.

Sinner has not played since July, when he won **Wimbledon** for the second year in a row. In an Instagram video, he said he and his doctors decided his knee needs **treatment**. He said he "needed to think about my long-term **career**."

Sinner still had a great year. He won 44 **singles** matches and lost only three. He won six **titles** on hard, clay and grass courts. He also beat his **rival**, Carlos Alcaraz, to become number one.

Now Alexander Zverev, who is ranked second, will likely become number one by the end of the year. Zverev won the French Open and the US Open this year.

Word Treasure

Wimbledon -- Wimbledon is a famous tennis tournament played on grass in England.

treatment -- Treatment is the care doctors give to help someone heal.

career -- A career is the work a person does over many years.

singles -- Singles is tennis played one player against one player.

rival -- A rival is someone you often compete against.

titles -- Titles are championships won at tournaments.

Background you need

Tennis players earn points for winning matches, and the player with the most points is number one.

Tennis is played on different courts, like hard courts, clay and grass.

Athletes sometimes rest for a long time so an injury can heal.

Break it down

WHO: Jannik Sinner, the number one men's tennis player in the world

WHAT: He will not play again in 2026

WHERE: Men's professional tennis, where Alexander Zverev may become the new number one

WHY: He has a hurt right knee that needs treatment

Why it matters

Sinner shows that taking time to heal an injury is important, even for the best athletes.

Test what you remember

1. Why will Jannik Sinner not play again in 2026?

- ☐ (A) He lost his racket
- ☐ (B) He is moving to the Moon
- ☐ (C) He has a hurt right knee
- ☐ (D) He wants to sing

2. Which country is Sinner from?

- ☐ (A) Italy
- ☐ (B) France
- ☐ (C) Spain
- ☐ (D) Germany

3. What did Sinner win in July?

- ☐ (A) Wimbledon
- ☐ (B) The World Cup
- ☐ (C) The Super Bowl
- ☐ (D) The Olympics

4. How many singles matches did Sinner lose this year?

- ☐ (A) Zero
- ☐ (B) Six
- ☐ (C) Three
- ☐ (D) Forty-four

5. Whom did Sinner beat to become number one?

- ☐ (A) His coach
- ☐ (B) His brother
- ☐ (C) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (D) Alexander Zverev

6. Who will likely become number one by the end of the year?

- ☐ (A) Alexander Zverev
- ☐ (B) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (C) Nobody
- ☐ (D) Jannik Sinner

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Jannik Sinner: He said he needed to think about his long-term career.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):